



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*tasmād ajñāna-sambhūtaṃ hr̥t-sthaṃ jñānāsinātmanaḥ |
chittvainaṃ saṃśayaṃ yogam ātiṣṭhotttiṣṭha bhārata | | [Gītā 4.42]
baladevaḥ :
jñānataḥ karmaṇaḥ śraiṣṭhyaṃ sukaratvādinā hariḥ |
śuddhasya tad-akartṛtvaṃ tvety ādi prāha pañcame | |*

— Bhagavadgītā-4comm with the commentaries of Śrīdhara, Madhusūdana, Viśvanātha and Baladeva, Chapter 1, Verse

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GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Therefore, having severed this doubt born of ignorance with the sword of self-knowledge that dwells in your heart, resort to yoga. Arise, O Bharata! This verse, 4.42 of the Bhagavad Gītā, chapter four, encapsulates the heart of Krishna's message to Arjuna. It is a call to action, a directive to cut through the crippling paralysis of doubt that stems from misunderstanding our true nature. Baladeva clarifies that Krishna extols the superiority of knowledge over action because of its ease, and in the fifth chapter, He explains that a purified soul is not the doer of actions.

The doubt Krishna refers to is not simple questioning; it's the deeply ingrained uncertainty about our purpose, our path, and our ability to achieve liberation. It's the voice that whispers, "You're not good enough," "You'll never succeed," or "What's the point?" This doubt, Krishna says, is born of ignorance – a lack of understanding of our true self, the Ātman, which is inherently connected to the Divine.

The "sword of self-knowledge" is not a literal weapon, but the discriminative power of wisdom gained through introspection, study, and devotion. It's the ability to see through the illusions of the material world and recognize the eternal truth of our being. This knowledge is not something external to be acquired but something already present within the heart, waiting to be awakened.

"Yoga" here refers not just to physical postures, but to the union with the Divine, the practice of aligning our thoughts, words, and actions with our true nature. By resorting to yoga, we transcend the limitations of the ego and experience the boundless freedom of the spirit.

The call to "arise" is a call to action, a summons to embrace our dharma, our duty, with courage and conviction. It is a reminder that we are not passive observers in this cosmic drama, but active participants, capable of shaping our own destiny. In modern life, this verse encourages you to confront your own doubts and insecurities, to seek the wisdom that lies within, and to live a life of purpose and meaning. It teaches us to arm ourselves with the knowledge of our true nature and to actively engage in the pursuit of self-realization.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What limiting beliefs are you holding onto, and what small step can you take today to begin severing them with the sword of self-knowledge?